

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

<think> The patient is describing symptoms of persistent sadness , hopelessness , difficulty making decisions , and worsening suicidal ideations , which are common symptoms of depression .

The patient's history of feeling cursed and expecting bad things to happen to him suggests a pattern of negative thinking that is characteristic of depressive symptoms .

There is no mention of manic or psychotic symptoms , so option B is not the best answer .

Option C is correct as the patient is likely to show anhedonia , which is the inability to feel pleasure , which is a common symptom of depression .

Option D is not correct because paranoid personality disorder is not described by the patient's symptoms . </think>< answer > The patient is likely to show anhedonia . </answer >

